Learn Words About a New Subject

Vocabulary Words

approximate
calculate
certain
estimation
probability

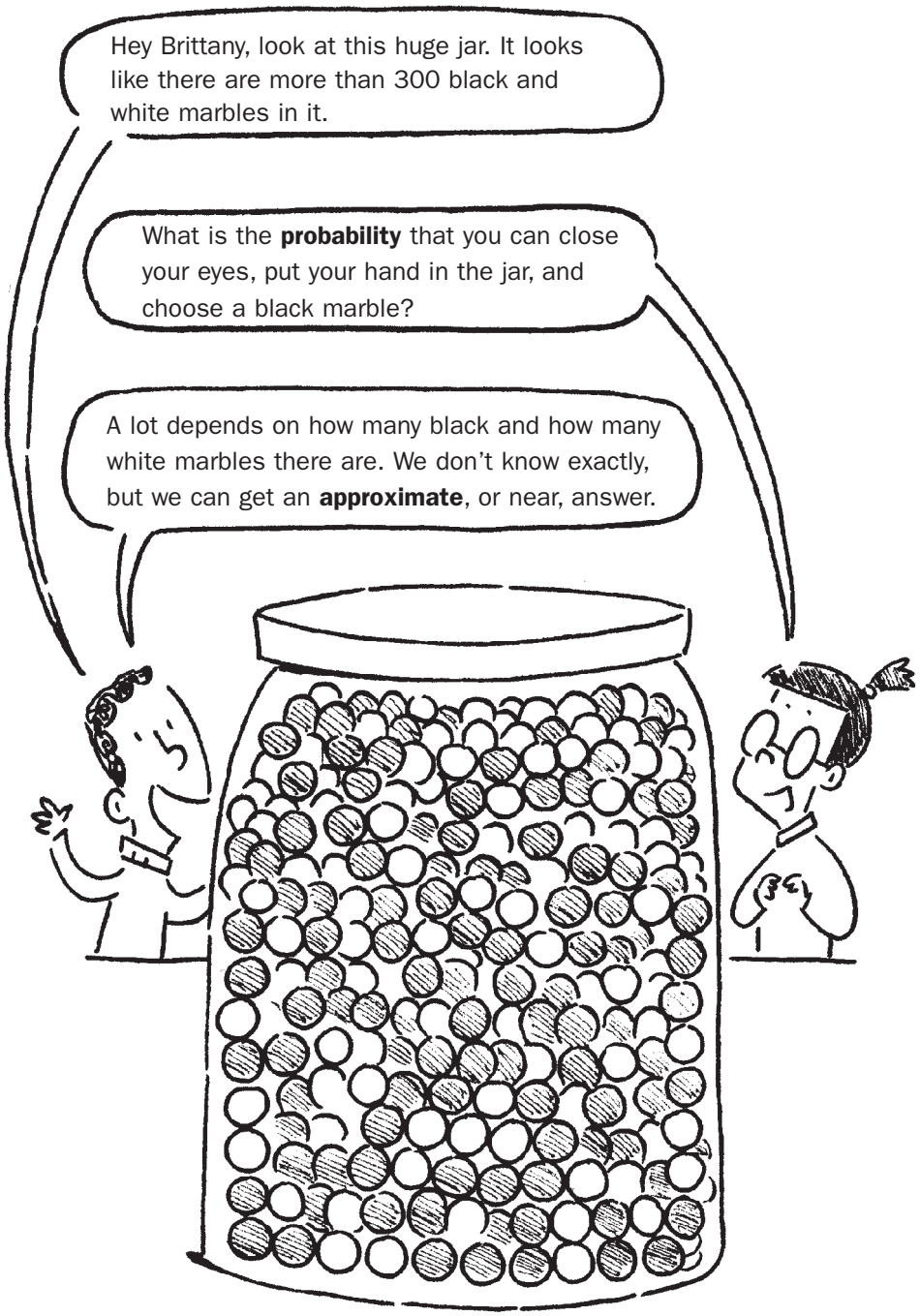
Word Learning Tip!

When you read about a new subject in school, you often see new content words. These words relate to a specific subject, so you have to know them to understand what you are reading. You see these words over and over again when you read about the topic. They are not words that you see in most other books. A clue to their meaning is that they give information about the subject you are studying.

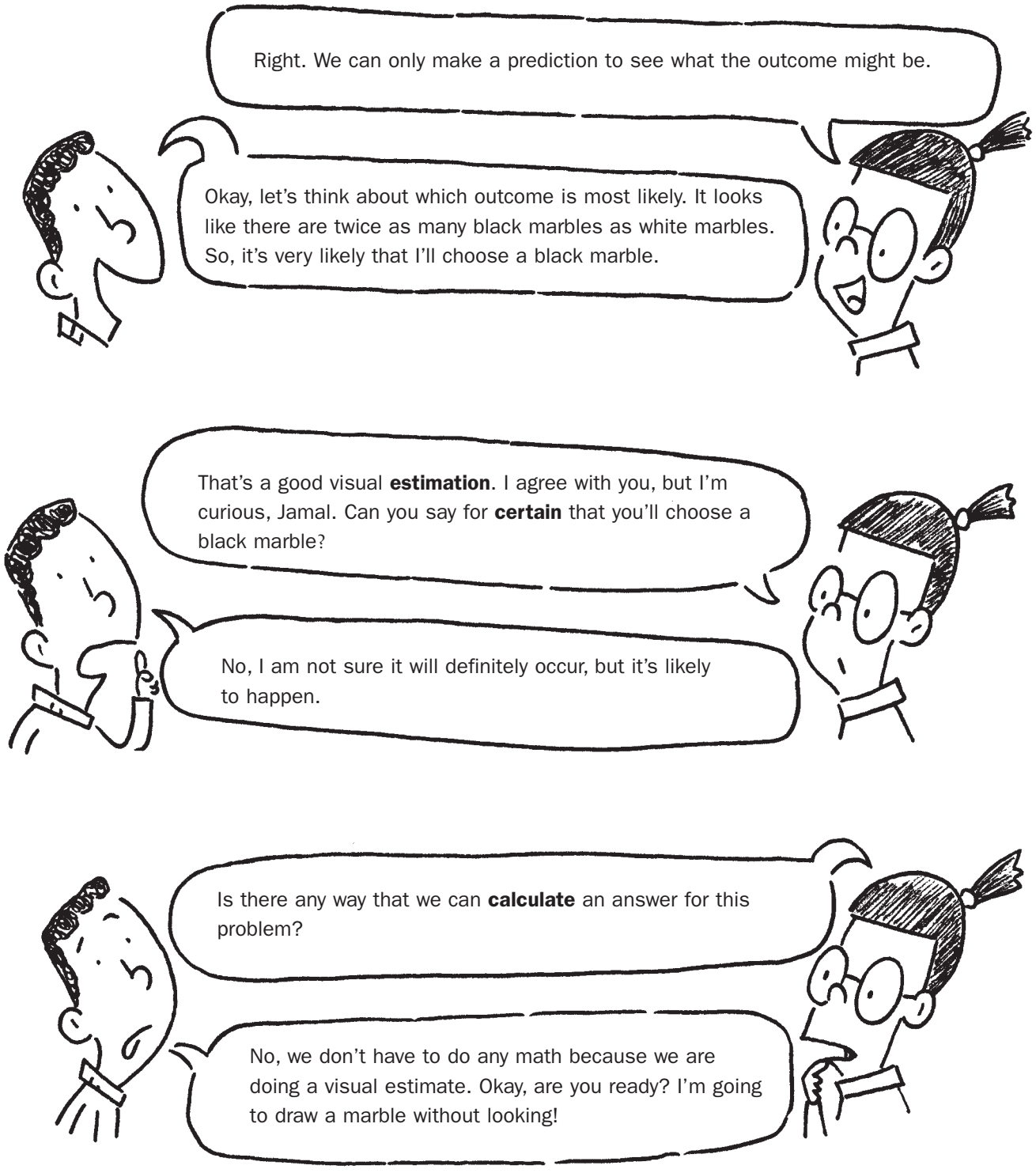
Vocabulary Building Strategy

As you read content words, you can think about how they relate to the main subject. You can also see how they are similar to other content words in a passage. Then you can connect content words to the big idea of the material you are reading to learn the meaning of each new word. All of the words in this lesson deal with the concept of problem solving.

Directions As you read the story below, think about how the words in boldface are linked to the concept of problem solving.



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Connect Words and Meanings

approximate	calculate	certain	estimation	probability

Directions Write the vocabulary word in the blank next to each definition. You may use your glossary to help you.

_____ **1.** an answer that you believe is close to the exact answer; the act of coming up with an answer that is close to the exact answer

_____ **2.** more or less correct or exact; to come up with an answer that is more or less correct

_____ **3.** how likely something is to happen

_____ **4.** will definitely happen; sure that something will happen

_____ **5.** to find the answer by using mathematics

Directions Write the correct vocabulary word in the blank to complete each sentence.

6. Sometimes you don't need an exact answer because a(n) _____ will be close enough.

7. Beth is _____ that she will pick a green marble from the bag because all the marbles are green.

8. You can _____ that 10% of $20.00 is $2.00 by moving the decimal point one digit to the left.

9. The teacher asked us to give a(n) _____ answer, not an exact one.

10. If you toss a penny 100 times, the _____ is that it will land on "heads" about 50 times.

Review of Chapter 2: Word Parts and Content Words Many words can be made into new words by adding word parts to them. Add a suffix, take off a suffix, or change a suffix to see how many new words you can make from the five vocabulary words. Write a sentence using each new word.

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Use Content Words

approximate	calculate	certain	estimation	probability

Directions Write the correct vocabulary word to complete each problem-solving tip. You will use each word twice.

Tip #1: When all the tiles in a jar are the same color, you can be _____ that you will choose a tile that is that color.

Tip #2: When you _____ the sum of very large numbers, be sure to double-check your answers to make sure that you didn't add them incorrectly.

Tip #3: If an event is impossible, its _____ is 0.

Tip #4: Sometimes a(n) _____ answer will be satisfactory, but at other times you need an exact answer.

Tip #5: When you round up to the nearest 10, you use the process of _____.

Tip #6: If something will absolutely happen, it's _____ is 1.

Tip #7: It is often helpful to _____ an answer to a mathematical problem by using visual aids.

Tip #8: When all the marbles in a jar are the same color, you can be absolutely _____ that you won't choose any marble that is another color.

Tip #9: Round off numbers or use _____ to check your answers.

Tip #10: Often you don't need to know the exact amount of money you've spent so far in a store, you just need to know the _____ amount.

Research a Famous Problem Solver Choose a famous problem solver and explain how he or she added to our knowledge of mathematics. For instance, who was the first person to estimate the number of stars in the sky? Who made certain we had electricity, air flight, computer chips, cell phones, ATMs, etc.? Use all of the vocabulary words in your report.

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Put Words Into Action

approximate	calculate	certain	estimation	probability

Directions Read each word problem. Then write the word that best fits to answer each question.

1. Jesse has to be at work at 9:00 A.M. It takes him 15 minutes to get dressed, 20 minutes to eat, and 35 minutes to walk to work. What time should he get up?

   How can you _____ exactly when Jesse has to get up?

2. On Thursday, the store sells 1,572 books. On Friday it sells 1,953 books. On Saturday, it sells 152 books less than on Friday. How many books are sold in all three days? If you round the book sales, you would get a(n) _____ answer.

3. Rachel and Shawn went to San Juan. The flight to San Juan was five hours and fifteen minutes. On the return trip, the flight took four hours and thirty-five minutes. Use _____ to figure out how long the round trip took to the nearest 10 minutes.

4. There are 100 marbles in a jar. 25 marbles are green. 75 marbles are orange. How _____ are you that you will choose an orange marble?

5. Suppose 25 pieces of paper in a hat are numbered 1 through 25. What is the _____ that you will pick the same number twice in 100 picks?

6. Carla's Cake Place baked 50 chocolate cookies yesterday. Today 32 cookies are left. How many cookies have been sold? 20 cookies would be a(n) _____ answer rather than an exact one.

7. Derek is trying to solve this problem: $153 + 47 - 22 = 46 - 40 + x$.

   How can you _____ the answer for this problem?

8. You and a friend are playing a board game. The spinner is divided into 4 equal parts—red, blue, green, and yellow. What is the _____ that you will land on red 5 times out of 25 spins.

Write a Probability Problem Work with a partner. Think about a probability problem in which you pose a question about a possible outcome. On a separate sheet of paper, write the problem. Use as many vocabulary words as possible, along with other words that relate to probability outcomes.

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Review and Extend

approximate	calculate	certain	estimation	probability

Bonus Words Below are three new words about the big idea of this lesson. These are more long words that you would read in a math book. This tells you that you're already starting out with a clue: all of these words are about problem solving!

reasonable sensible; logical
likelihood chance or probability
strategy plan for solving a problem

Directions Read each sentence below. Choose the vocabulary word or the new content word that best completes each sentence. Write the word in the blank.

1. The word problem required only a(n) _____ answer, but the students had to make sure that it was _____ and made sense.
2. When the _____ or _____ of an event occurring is 1, you can say that you are absolutely _____ the event will happen.
3. You can use _____ to solve a visual mathematical problem because you don't need an exact answer nor do you need to _____ any numbers.
4. When you develop a _____, you make a plan for solving the problem.
5. The old adage, "Lightning never strikes twice," indicates the _____ or _____ that lightning will strike again in the same place is 0.

Search for More Words About Probability Look through some math textbooks or look at some web sites on the Internet. In your personal journal, write a list of as many new words as you can find or think of that relate to *probability*.

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Check Your Mastery

Directions Read each item below. Then write the vocabulary word that best completes each sentence.

1. Ashley knows that it is _____ that the marble she chooses will be red because all the marbles in the jar are red.
A. probability **B.** estimation **C.** certain

2. The closer the _____ is to 1, the more likely the event is to occur.
A. certain **B.** probability **C.** approximate

3. Since he knows his multiplication tables, Juan can _____ in his head very quickly the total cost of four shirts that are $14.99 each. His answers are always correct, too!
A. approximate **B.** calculate **C.** certain

4. The surveyor needed a(n) _____ rather than an exact number, so he rounded the measurement to the nearest ten.
A. estimation **B.** probability **C.** calculate

5. The _____ number of guests was too far from a precise answer to be useful, so Maria had to count every name on the list.
A. approximate **B.** calculate **C.** certain

Directions Read the passage below. Then select the vocabulary words that best fit the context. Write the words in the blanks. Use each vocabulary word only once.

Lucia wanted to figure out the chance or **6.**_____ (*calculate, probability, certain*) of a coin landing on "heads" if she tossed it 200 times. Before she tossed the coin, she knew that she could not **7.**_____ (*calculate, certain, approximate*) an exact answer. To select a(n) **8.**_____ (*approximate, estimation, certain*) answer, she chose a number that she thought would be close to the exact answer. She jotted down her **9.**_____ (*estimation, calculate, approximate*) so she could compare it against the outcome. After she tossed the coin and counted the number of heads, she could be **10.**_____ (*calculate, estimation, certain*) of her answer.

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